Facebook Surround 360

Facebook unveiled a reference design for a 360 degree video camera that it plans to release on Github, as an open source project. Known as the Facebook Surround 360, the 17-camera system is shaped like a flying saucer and can capture and render images in 360 automatically. According to Facebook, its reference design solves a number of problems with VR cameras today and implored manufacturers to use its design for their own products.

Further, the reference design by Facebook, uses 14 wide angle cameras and three fish-eye cameras (two at the bottom and one on top). This, according to Facebook, ensures that the camera can capture all of its surroundings, without needing to show the pole that it's been mounted on. This is a very real problem in the current VR shooting systems. Facebook even presented a demo video, shot with the camera, using the Samsung Gear VR.

The company claims that the Facebook Surround 360 can run for long durations without overheating. It can shoot 8K, and videos can be viewed on Facebook, Samsung Gear VR and Oculus Rift.

Ossic X

VR headsets have become commercial and are already shipping to customers. While we have come a long way in improving and getting close to a perfect immersive experience inside the headset with visuals, audio seems to be left behind. The current VR headsets let you connect your own headset for audio but it's a point where the immersion breaks. Ossic headphones want to fill in the gap with their 3D headphone that promises to offer a more realistic audio experience. The Ossic X employs sensors added in the headphones that constantly measure the position of the head and ears. It makes use of head-related transfer function, which is a measure used to locate the source of a sound. Since the shape and size of everyone's ear differs from one another, such a measure to adapt to the user's ears is necessary to emulate 3D audio. It uses multiple drivers to throw music from different areas of the cup to your ears. The virtualisation of the 3D audio is done through proprietary software adjusting to the anatomy of your ear where moving your head affects the sound output. The headphones connect to your PC using the standard 3.5mm headphone jack. Priced at around ₹26k, the Ossic X is directed towards VR gamers looking for a more immersive virtual experience.

Moodbox

Artifical Intelligence has come a long way where we already see autonomous machines pulling off incredibly complex tasks believed to be possible only by humans. Sitting at its heart is Emi, the intelligent machine that learns your taste in music you listen to throughout the day and in various weather conditions. As you listen to more songs, the machine improves on recommendations using its analytical algorithms, churning out music based on your mood or activity. It gets better. Apparently, it can even track your mood by analysing your speech. This is further improved by Moodbox asking you questions and in a way having a conversation with you. The device supports a multiroom setup so you will be able to connect multiple Moodboxes around your house to play the same song or different songs through each speaker. Fresh out of a succesful Indiegogo campaign, there is no final word on its final market price, but one could acquire it by paying a cost of ₹10k.